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SIT317 - IT Innovations & Entrepreneurships
Insu Oh, Gia Kiet Huynh, Neil Pansuria, Ben White, Jaylem Alves

BUSINESS PROPOSAL

Breaking Workplace Barriers through Robotic Telepresence

Prepared for:

Dr Elicia Lanham
& SIT317 Teaching Team

Prepared by:

NeoConnect .Inc
Trung Kien Do - s223915815

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Executive Summary

Company Overview

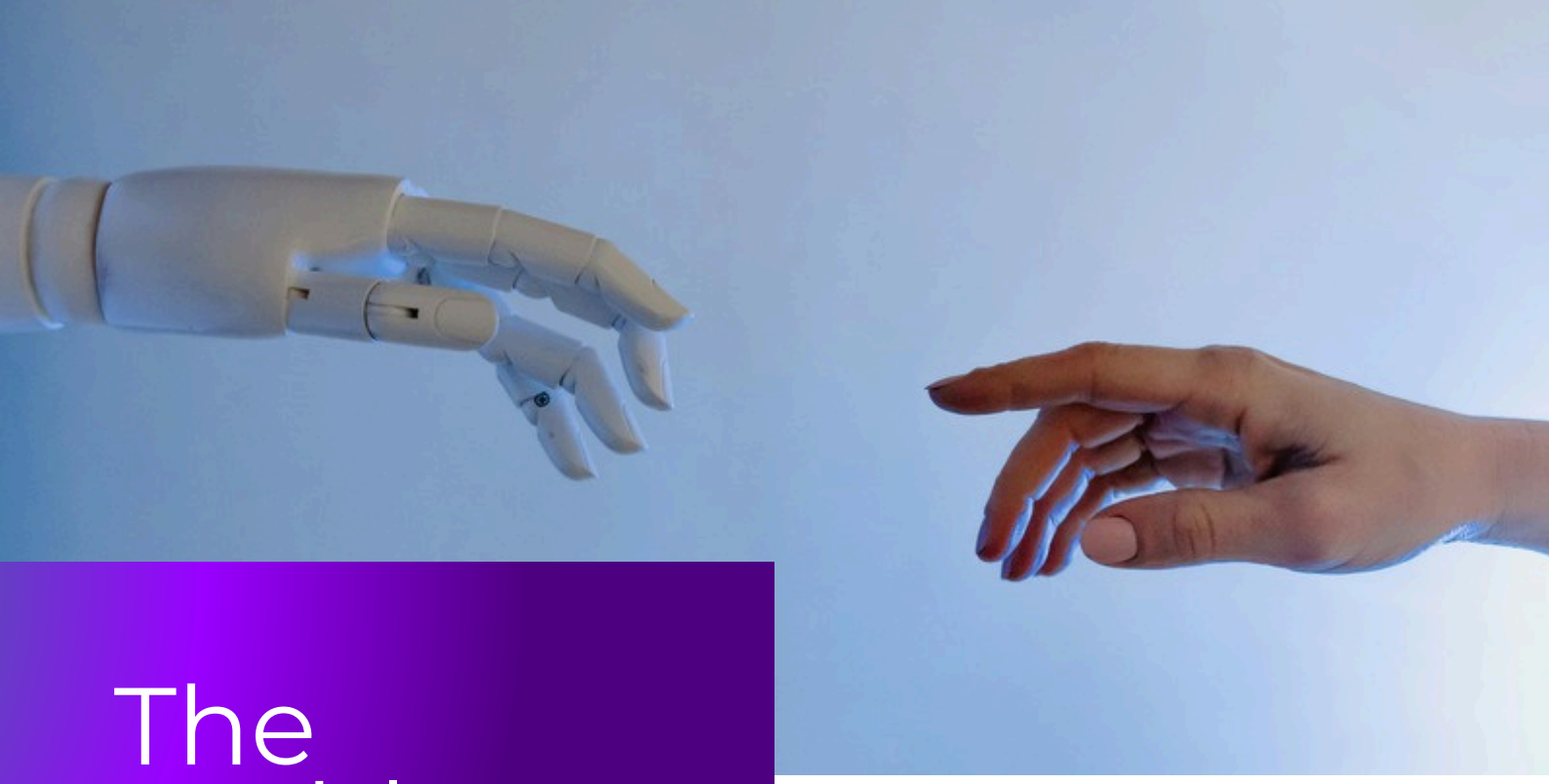
NeoConnect is a new startup company that leverages robotics, telepresence, and immersive technology to give people with disabilities and the aging to chance to rejoin the workforce in meaningful ways. By bridging the gap between physical workplaces and remote accessibility, NeoConnect assists businesses in overcoming labour shortages while also fostering inclusivity and innovation in the modern job market.

Vision

To be the global leader in inclusive telepresence and robotic workforce solutions, transforming how people with disabilities participate in and shape the future of work

Mission

The goal of NeoConnect is to provide businesses with a scalable, inclusive, and future-ready workforce model by offering creative and easily accessible telepresence services that allow workers with disabilities to work with confidence.



The Problem

Disability rate & Unemployment

Australia's aging and physically disabled population is experiencing a serious crisis with regard to employment inclusion. Nearly **4.8 million** of the 5.5 million Australians with disabilities struggle with basic tasks like self-care, communication, or mobility. Compared to **84%** of Australians without disabilities, only 53% of working-age individuals with disabilities are employed. At **10%**, their unemployment rate is still disproportionately high and more than twice that of those without disabilities. Many people who are excluded are not limited by their ability or motivation, but rather by structural barriers such as inaccessible workplaces, and a need for physical presence.

Broaden Scope

Since the beginning, our team has been committed to filling this gap. But as our research progressed, we broadened our focus to include experienced professionals who are left out of a job because of age or acquired disabilities, even though they still possess important knowledge, decision-making, and leadership abilities. This broader perspective acknowledges that older Australians and people with disabilities experience exclusion due to a system that does not adjust to their needs, not a lack of talent.

Labor shortage

Meanwhile, service-based sectors like retail, hospitality, tourism, and customer service report high employee turnover and a lack of employees. These fields rely much more on empathy, product knowledge, and communication than on physical strength, which are exactly the skills that many older and disabled Australians can excel in.

The Solution & Design

Core Features

Our solution is a VR-enabled hiring and workplace integration platform. By combining accessible digital tools, immersive VR training, and telepresence robotics, employees can perform customer-facing service roles remotely, while businesses gain access to skilled talent without major workplace modifications.

Accessible Hiring and Training Platform

- Inclusive interface designed to WCAG 2.2 AA standards
- Job search, application, and progress tracking for pilots
- Interactive VR and video training modules tailored to robot operation and specific job

Benefit: Reduce entry barriers and equip employees with confidence

Telepresence Robots

- High-definition cameras, microphones, and speakers
- Job-specific attachments (serving trays, displays, barista tools) or screen-based guidance interfaces
- Safety features include ultrasonic obstacle detection and mapped safe zones
- Real-time obstacle detection with ultrasonic sensors
- Accessible feedback via audio, visual, or haptic signals

Benefit: In-person performance remotely without extensive workplace modifications

VR integration

- Custom VR headset designed for accessibility and integration with telepresence controls
- Option to switch between VR, desktop, or mobile interface

Benefit: Enhance sense of presence and collaboration with on-site colleagues

Flexible control modes

- Map-based, joystick, or simplified preset navigation
- Support eye-tracking, voice commands, and gestures.

Benefits: Accommodates varying physical abilities

Value Propositiion

NeoConnect differentiate itself by offering:

01
Streamline recruitment process that ensure businesses efficiently connect with qualified candidates with disabilities.

02
Realistic training scenarios with adaptive difficulty, real-time feedback, and performance analytics to prepare employees for diverse roles

03
Robotics and IoT connectivity to enable remote customer-facing work, ensuring seamless collaboration without requiring workplace revamp

04
Enhances workforce diversity, fills labor shortages, and empowers individuals with disabilities to work independently.

Business Model

NeoConnect operates on a Robot-as-a-Service (RaaS) subscription model, offering a tiered plan for businesses of varying sizes. Employers pay recurring fees that cover robot access, training, and platform integration. A dedicated share of subscription revenue is directed to employee wages, ensuring fair compensation and sustainable livelihoods for workers with disabilities. Costs are further offset through government and NGO partnerships, and in some regions, optional employee co-contribution models strengthen long-term sustainability.

Revenue Streams

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Business Subscriptions

Businesses pay a recurring fee based on the number of robots, employee seats, and platform features.

Government & NGO Partnerships

Accessibility and inclusion programs help cover adoption costs, boosting small - medium enterprise participation while ensuring stable revenue

Seed/Angel Investment

In regions where allowed, employees contribute a small portion of income, with safeguards for fair pay and stable wages.

Value-Add Services

Extra revenue from VR training, robot upgrades, maintenance, and analytics, creating ongoing growth beyond subscriptions.

Solution Design (Low-fidelity Prototype)

The NeoConnect Robot Control UI is built to prioritize accessibility, intuitive navigation, and operational safety, enabling employees with disabilities to operate telepresence robots effectively in customer-facing environments.

Controls Annotations

01
Navigation & Monitoring (Top bar)
Top bar includes employee profile, mapped navigation, emergency stop, battery level, day/time display, connectivity status, notifications, and settings

02
Input methods (Left-side bar)
Toggle between eye-tracking mode, voice activation and joystick control buttons

03
Arm control presets (Bottom-right)
Buttons for predefined gestures, camera assisted alignment, and customize preset button

04
Output and Communication methods (Right-side bar)
Preset responses, Test to speech, and microphone toggle button

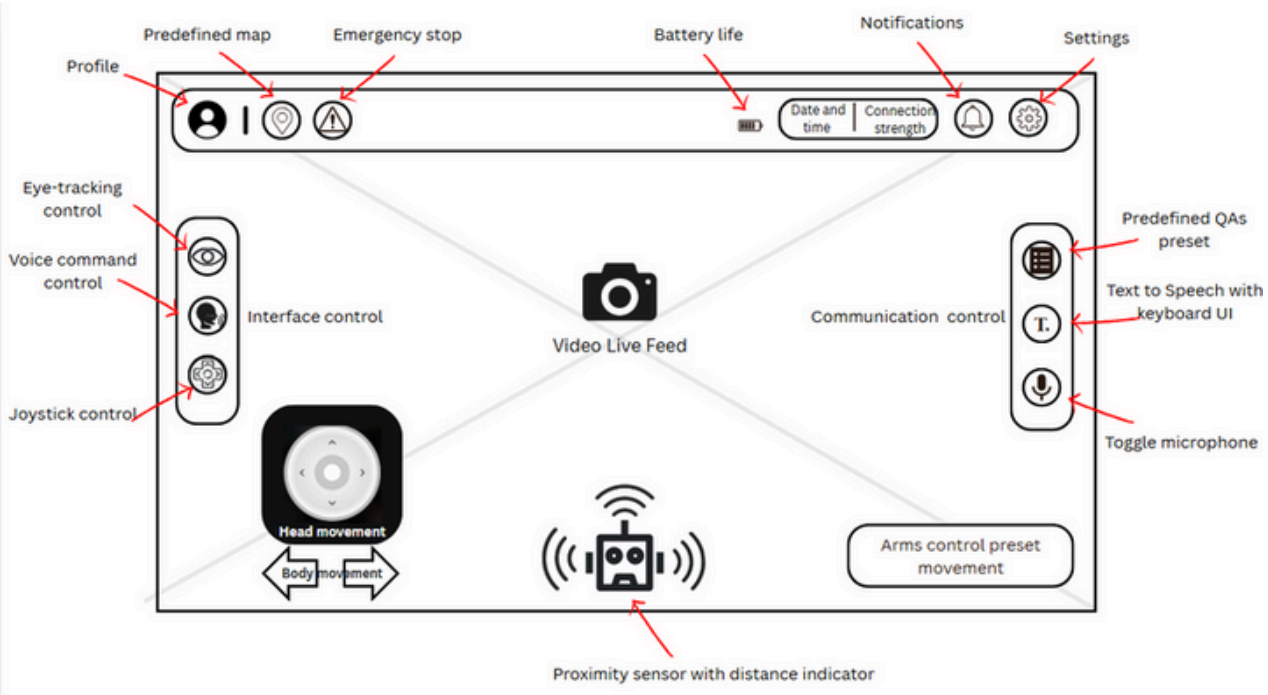
05
Proximity Sensor (Bottom-middle)
Sensor display with color-coded alerts

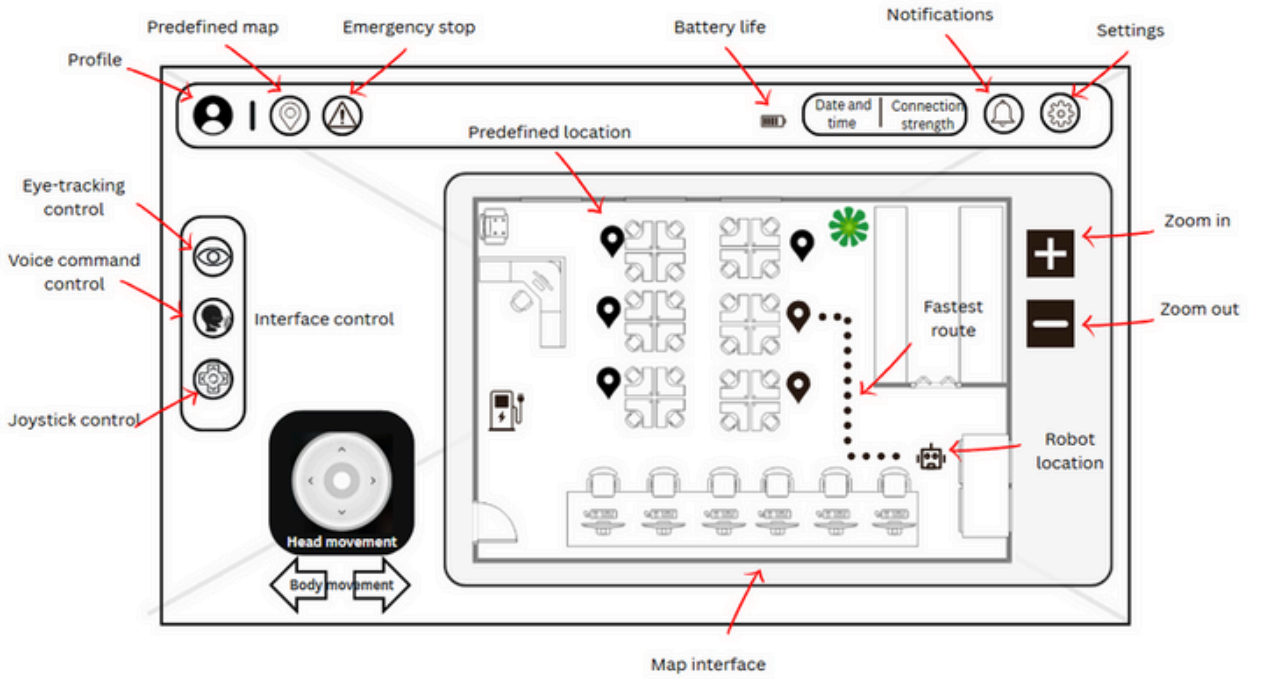
Testing Approach

Alpha Testing (Internal Team)
Focus on validating core system functions, identifying bugs, and resolving inconsistencies. Responsiveness across different devices will also be assessed to ensure a stable foundation before broader testing.

Beta Testing (Controlled user group)
During this phase, the development team will closely monitor user interaction patterns, the effectiveness of safety features (such as emergency stop and sensor feedback), and the performance of various input and output methods. At the end of the testing, feedback will be gathered on usability, accessibility, and overall user experience, which will guide refinements in the final design.

Solution Design
(Low-fidelity Prototype)





Competitors Analysis

A comparative analysis of two notable competitors in the telepresence robotics market: Orihime-D and Temi Robot. While both offer remote interaction capabilities, they differ significantly in design, target audience, and application focus. This analysis aims to highlight their strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats, providing insight into how our solution differentiates itself in addressing the unique needs of the core target audience.

OryLaboratory Inc. Orihime-D

Strengths	Weaknesses	Opportunities	Threats
Specialized design for remote physical tasks. Focus on social inclusion. Proven use cases in various setting	Limited international availability Niche market focus	Global market expansion Healthcare and education partnerships Technological improvements	Competition from other robotic business Regulatory barriers

Temi USA Inc.

Strengths	Weaknesses	Opportunities	Threats
Multi-industry use User-friendly interface Robust navigation and sensors	Not tailored for severe disabilities individuals	Disability customization Assistive technology integration	Competition Rapid technological advancements

Industry & Market Analysis

Customer Discovery

People with disabilities make up a sizable and expanding portion of Australia's population, and their needs in terms of employment participation are obviously unmet. Determining NeoConnect's opportunity requires an understanding of this group's size, demographics, and employment barriers. The core customers and their possible connection with our solution are highlighted in the breakdown that follows.

01 Australia Disability Rate

There are 5.5 million people with disabilities in Australia, making up 21.4% of the total population. This is a notable increase from 17.7% in 2018, showing a rising demographic trend.

02 Disabled Working-Age Rate

Of the total, 2.7 million Australians with disabilities are of working age (15–64).

03 Disabled Employment Gap

The employment rate for working-age people with disabilities is 48% (984,000 people), compared to 80% (11.3 million) for those without disabilities. For individuals with severe disabilities, employment drops further to just 24% (120,000 people).

04 Permanently Excluded Workforce

A particularly undeserved group includes the 482,400 people with disabilities who are considered permanently unable to work under traditional employment models. This group, alongside the 863,000 people with moderate disabilities seeking flexible roles

Market Growth

The telepresence robotics industry is experiencing strong global expansion, driven by rising demand for remote work solutions, healthcare applications, and accessibility technologies. The following table highlights the projected market growth at both global and Australian levels:

Market	2024	2030 - 2035	CAGR
Telepresence robots (global market)	$303.1M	$2,038M	18.9%
Medical telepresence robots (global market)	$80.3M	$225.7M	18.8%
Australian medical telepresence	$0.82M	$2.3M	18.8%

Go-To-Market Plan & Funding

Go-to-Market Plan

From our research, we identified several key strategies that have historically worked in the robotics sector and that would, theoretically, apply to NeoConnect's growth path:

01 Strategic partnerships

- **NGOs & Disability Advocacy groups:** Help gain credibility by reaching their target audience
- **Government Agencies:** helps support accessibility law compliance, workforce inclusion, and reduce welfare dependency
- **Employers & Pilot Program**: help demonstrate proof-of-concept with case studies
- **Healthcare & Rehabilitation Centers:** Integrate solution into recovery journeys

02 Pilot programs & Case Studies

- Launch controlled pilots in industries and countries that are supportive.
- Collect outcomes, feedback, and produce marketing case studies to demonstrate impact

03 Social Media & Awareness

- Social media campaigns showcasing user stories and benefits.
- Collaborate with disability networks and advocacy groups to improve reach

04 Sales & scaling

- Offer subscription packages for businesses
- Distribute via online channels, healthcare distributors, and government programs
- Expand internationally via localization, partnerships, and target campaigns

Initial Fundings

NeoConnect has studied the funding trajectories of prior robotics ventures and identified the three most effective strategies for early growth and sustainability

Early-stage Funding

Early-stage funding comes from government grants and NGO partnerships to support pilots and reduce adoption barriers for small businesses

Seed/Angel Investment

Seed or angel investment may be used to scale robot fleets, enhance platform features, and support initial marketing efforts

Subscriptions

Subscription income from the pilot program is then reinvested to verify the market and guarantee that employees are paid fairly.

Expansion & Global Strategy

Three Phases Expansion Plan

NeoConnect's growth strategy is structured in clear phases, beginning with rapid market penetration in industries facing immediate workforce shortages, followed by expansion into new sectors, and finally scaling geographically with enhanced technologies.

Phase 1
3 - 6 months

Market Penetration

Focus on the service industry, which includes cafes, restaurants, and hospitality businesses experiencing labour shortages

Robot-as-a-Service subscription model, offering tiered packages that suits businesses of different sizes

Secure initial funding through government grants and NGO partnerships to first cover adoption costs and to quickly enter the market. Then afterwards seed and angel investment

Phase 2
6 - 18 months

Enter New Market

Expand services into the Education Sector. Support remote learning and assist students with disabilities

Expand into corporate offices, providing a remote solution for employees with disabilities

Introduce telepresence robots in hospitals and rehabilitation centers to help with staff training and patient care. This aligns with the growing trend of robotics integration in healthcare.

Phase 2
6 - 18 months

Geographic and Technological Expansion

Expand internationally, enter new markets with supportive inclusion policies, such as Europe and North America. Collaborate with local distributors and government programs to facilitate market entry

Integrate AI capabilities to enable semi-autonomous robot tasks, creating additional revenue streams through advanced features and services

Final Thoughts & Next Steps

Summary of Business Proposal

NeoConnect presents an inclusive, technology-driven employment solution that combines VR hiring, immersive training, and telepresence robotics. The proposal highlights:

An Innovative solution with strong market potential, and scalability across industries

Commitment to a social cause by enabling dignified, flexible, and meaningful work while supporting employers' diversity and inclusion goals.

Three-phase growth strategy ensuring expansion into healthcare and enterprise, and long-term international scaling to capture global telepresence market growth.

Sustainable revenue model with recurring subscription income reinforced by government partnerships, value-add services, and scalable adoption pathways.

Investment Opportunity

We invite investors, partners, and policy collaborators to join us in scaling NeoConnect's solution across Australia and beyond. By partnering with NeoConnect, stakeholders will benefit from:

High growth market potential
Access to a rapidly expanding disability employment market.

Strong revenue stream
Scalable long-term revenue streams through subscriptions and value-add services.

Entry to growing sector
Early positioning in a sector projected for double-digit CAGR growth.

Next Steps & Contact Information

NeoConnect is ready to engage with investors, businesses, and government partners to accelerate market adoption and our global vision. The next steps include:

Pilot Program Partnerships
Collaborate with key industries to validate impact

Strategic Funding Rounds
Secure seed/angel investment and government grants.

Global Scaling Roadmap
Enter international markets with favorable inclusion policies.

For further discussions and investment inquiries, please contact

+61 400 123 456 www.neoconnect.com Melbourne, Australia

We look forward to building the future of inclusive workplace with telepresence robot together

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